

POWERING THE THIRD WAVE



IMAGE BY RAJESH ANGIRA/AI

**BUILDING
GLOBAL FROM
DAY ONE**

**TECHNOLOGY IS
THE COMPETITIVE
ADVANTAGE**

**AI IS THE
BUDDY
FOUNDER**

**RAISE
LESS, CREATE
MORE**

**THINK
FOR
DECADES**

**THINKING
BEYOND TRADITIONAL
DEGREE TAGS**

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no longer content with adapting successful global ideas or building businesses purely for rapid scale.

Instead, they are chasing technology breakthroughs, targeting global markets from inception and measuring success by the durability of the institutions they create than the speed at which they become unicorns.

BUILDING INSTITUTIONS

Perhaps the sharpest departure from the previous generation lies in how these founders think about the endgame. For many consumer Internet entrepreneurs, building, scaling and eventually exiting a company became an accepted entrepreneurial cycle.

But founders building start-ups in frontier technologies argue that mindset simply doesn't work for businesses whose products can take years, even decades, to mature.

For Sharma, sectors such as space, defence and semiconductors require a fundamentally different horizon. "I want to build a generational company that truly moves the needle for humanity."

Airbound's Pushp echoes that sentiment. "I want to build one

of those companies that meaningfully reshapes humanity," he says.

Kamath believes that building enduring companies will also require founders to look beyond crowded AI markets and solve problems with global relevance.

Taken together, the Gen Z founder playbook rests on a few common principles—building globally from day one, prioritising technology over valuation, using capital efficiently, hiring for ownership rather than hierarchy, and measuring success by the institution a company becomes rather than the speed at which it reaches unicorn status.

The latest start-up wave is attempting to build enduring institutions from India that compete with the world's best. **BT**

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